BİLİŞİM VADİSİ | 42 TÜRKİYE | VAKIF KATILIM

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FOUNDATION HERITAGE INVENTORY PROJECT — INFORMATION NOTE

SUBJECT AND SCOPE

The Foundation Heritage Inventory Project is a comprehensive cultural heritage initiative carried out by Vakıf Katılım to photograph and document historic waqf properties across different cities using scientific methods and preserve them for future generations.

The project records mosques, madrasas, inns, hammams, fountains, tombs and other historic waqf properties individually. Historical descriptions are prepared in Turkish and English, and inventory books are produced with high-resolution photographs. Following a city-based approach, the project examines each province within the context of its cultural heritage, historic character and waqf tradition.

Launched in Hatay in 2022, the project continued in Konya, with work in Bursa and Kütahya completed in 2025. Work in İzmir and Manisa began in 2026.

PURPOSE AND INSTITUTIONAL APPROACH

The project's primary purpose is to highlight the historical, architectural and social legacy of waqf culture in cities and create a reliable reference resource that supports the preservation, understanding and transmission of this heritage to future generations. The inventories are intended to serve as references for future restoration projects and academic research.

In this respect, the project extends beyond publishing: it is a long-term social responsibility initiative dedicated to preserving cultural memory and passing it on to future generations. Waqf heritage is regarded as a living cultural legacy that continues to require protection and understanding today.

The Inventory Project reflects Vakıf Katılım's commitment to social and cultural values, demonstrating how the institution embraces the concept of "waqf" in its name as a responsibility that responds to today's needs.

TARGET AUDIENCE

The project's primary audience is the general public. This includes arts and culture enthusiasts, people interested in history and urban memory, academics, students, researchers and anyone seeking to develop an awareness of cultural heritage.

Communication activities and the digital experience should therefore be clear, accessible and easy to understand, appealing to general users as well as academic audiences.

CITY-BASED STUDIES AND PROJECT DATA

Hatay | 2022

- Experts documented 117 historic waqf properties through 2,600 photographs, compiling them alongside their histories in the book *Hatay Waqf Heritage*.
- Architectural details were photographed using mathematical calculations to provide reference material for potential restoration work.
- The book was prepared in Turkish and English and made available digitally alongside the printed publication.
- A selection of photographs was presented to the public at the “5 February Hatay” exhibition held at the Mimar Sinan Art Gallery.

Konya | 2024

- A total of 289 historic waqf properties were documented through 15,200 photographs and compiled alongside their histories in the book *Konya Waqf Heritage*.
- Prepared in Turkish and English, the book was published in print and made available as a PDF on Vakıf Katılım’s website.
- The “Ayna” (“Mirror”) exhibition, featuring photographs taken for the book, opened on 24 January 2025 at the Mimar Sinan Gallery in Üsküdar.

Bursa and Kütahya | 2025

- In Kütahya, 141 historic waqf properties were documented through 11,871 photographs.
- In Bursa, 385 historic waqf properties were recorded through 34,952 photographs.
- Inventory work in both provinces has been completed, and the books are currently undergoing printing and production.

İzmir and Manisa | 2026

- Work has begun to document historic waqf properties in İzmir and Manisa.
- The project is intended to continue expanding to additional cities.

EXPECTATIONS FOR THE DIGITAL PROJECT

The digital project is expected to complement the existing books, photography exhibitions and archival materials, bringing the inventory project to a wider audience. The aim is to make cultural heritage continuously accessible and discoverable through an interactive digital experience.

Key expectations include:

- **User experience:** Creating a user-friendly, mobile-responsive and fast digital platform with strong visual storytelling.
- **Content scope:** Presenting comprehensive information on the properties' histories and architectural and technical details, drawing on reliable external sources alongside Vakıf Katılım's resources.
- **Data fields:** Considering fields such as province, property name, property type, location, history, Turkish and English texts, photo galleries and exhibition information.
- **Discovery and filtering:** Where feasible, displaying properties on a map and enabling users to filter by city or property type.
- **Accessibility:** Developing solutions that address the needs of users with visual and hearing impairments, and considering a mobile application to complement the digital experience.
- **Sustainability:** Building a flexible, updatable infrastructure that allows new provinces and properties to be added over time.

The digital project should be positioned as a cultural platform that connects waqf heritage with people today, particularly younger generations. In doing so, it will highlight Vakıf Katılım's commitment to protecting cultural heritage while strengthening its image as an innovative institution that engages with young people.

RELATED LINKS

- Vakıf Katılım Publications
- Vakıf Katılım Preserves Hatay's Waqf Heritage
- Vakıf Katılım Preserves Hatay's Pre-Earthquake Appearance Through Photographs Taken the Day Before
- Photography Exhibition Marking the 700th Anniversary of the Conquest of Bursa
- TKBB – Vakıf Katılım Bank
- Vakıf Katılım Receives a Prestigious Award